Trade and Labor Market Dynamics: Rewriting as a Mean-Field Game

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1 Trade and Labor Market Dynamics Summary

Households have Cobb-Douglas preferences

$$C_t^{nj} = \prod_{k=1}^{J} \left(c_t^{nj,k}\right)^{\alpha^k}, \sum_{k=1}^{J} \alpha^k = 1$$

where $c_t^{nj,k}$ is the consumption of sector k goods in market nj at time t. The ideal price index is given by

$$P_t^n = \prod_{k=1}^{J} \left(\frac{P_t^{nk}}{\alpha^k}\right)^{\alpha^k}$$

where P_t^{nk} is the price index of goods purchased from sector k for final consumption in region n. Households are forward looking and discount the future rate $\beta \geq 0$. Migration decisions are subject to sectoral and spatial mobility costs. Labor relocation costs are given by $\tau^{nj,ik} \geq 0$ depend on the origin (nj) and destination (ik) are time invariant, additive, and measured in terms of utility. Households also have an additive idiosyncratic shocks for each choice, denoted by ε_t^{ik}.

At each period, households observe the conditions in all labor markets and the realizations of their own idiosyncratic shocks. If they begin the period in a labor market, they work and earn the market wage. At the end of the period, households have the option to relocate. Household decision to relocate is governed by

$$v_t^{nj} = U\left(C_t^{nj}\right) + \max_{\{i,k\}_{i=1,k=0}^{N,J}} \left\{\beta E\left[v_{t+1}^{ik}\right] - \tau^{nj,ik} + \nu\varepsilon_t^{ik}\right\}, \tag{1}$$

$$\text{s.t. } C_t^{nj} = \frac{w_t^{nj}}{P_t^n}$$

where v_t^{nj} is the lifetime utility of a household currently in region n and sector j at time t. We assume that idiosyncratic shocks are i.i.d. over time and distributed Type-1 Extreme Value with mean zero and ν controls the variance of these shocks.

The expected lifetime utility of a representative agent in market nj at time t is thus given by

$$V_t^{nj} \equiv E\left[v_t^{nj}\right]$$

and using the assumption of the distribution of the shocks, we can rewrite the expected lifetime utility as

$$V_t^{nj} = U\left(C_t^{nj}\right) + \nu \log\left(\beta \sum_{ik} \exp\left(\beta V_{t+1}^{ik} - \tau^{nj,ik}\right)^{1/\nu}\right) \tag{2}$$

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which is the Bellman equation of our dynamic programming (DP) problem. In a mean-field game, this can be thought of us as the backward equation. This process describes how decisions for the future are made.

The transition matrix governing the probabilities that agents relocate from market nj to ik is determined by

$$\mu_t^{nj,ik} = \frac{\exp\left(\beta V_{t+1}^{ik} - \tau^{nj,ik}\right)^{1/\nu}}{\sum_{mh} \exp\left(\beta V_{t+1}^{mh} - \tau^{nj,mh}\right)^{1/\nu}} \tag{3}$$

The transition matrix follows a gravity structure and the parameter $\frac{1}{\nu}$ can be interpreted as the elasticity of migration. The final equation that characterizes our DP problem is given by

$$L_{t+1}^{nj} = \sum_{ik} \mu_t^{ik,nj} L_t^{ik}$$

which describes the evolution of labor markets. Within the context of mean-field game, this would be the Kolmogorov forward equation.

2 Dynamic Programming I

In this section, we derive the components of the dynamic programming and its representation using "dynamic-hat algebra".

2.1 Deriving equation (2)

We first need to take the expectation of our lifetime utility over the idiosyncratic shocks ik.

$$\begin{aligned}
v_t^{nj} &= U\left(C_t^{nj}\right) + \max_{\{i,k\}_{i=1,k=0}^{N,J}} \left\{\beta E\left[v_{t+1}^{ik}\right] - \tau^{nj,ik} + \nu\varepsilon_t^{ik}\right\} \\
E\left[v_t^{nj}\right] &= E\left[U\left(C_t^{nj}\right) + \max_{\{i,k\}_{i=1,k=0}^{N,J}} \left\{\beta E\left[v_{t+1}^{ik}\right] - \tau^{nj,ik} + \nu\varepsilon_t^{ik}\right\}\right] \\
V_t^{nj} &= U\left(C_t^{nj}\right) + E\left[\max_{\{i,k\}_{i=1,k=0}^{N,J}} \left\{\beta V_{t+1}^{ik} - \tau^{nj,ik} + \nu\varepsilon_t^{ik}\right\}\right]
\end{aligned}$$

We are concerned with deriving a closed form solution for this term

$$\Phi_t^{nj} = E\left[\max_{\{i,k\}_{i=1,k=0}^{N,J}} \left\{\beta V_{t+1}^{ik} - \tau^{nj,ik} + \nu\varepsilon_t^{ik}\right\}\right]$$

When agents decide to relocate from market nj to ik, they need to choose a location that maximizes their expected lifetime utility. Suppose the solutions that maximizes our agent's expected lifetime utility is given by

$$\begin{aligned}
\text{argmax}_{\{i,k\}_{i=1,k=0}^{N,J}} \left\{\beta V_{t+1}^{ik} - \tau^{nj,ik} + \nu\varepsilon_t^{ik}\right\} &= ik \\
\max_{\{i,k\}_{i=1,k=0}^{N,J}} \left\{\beta V_{t+1}^{ik} - \tau^{nj,ik} + \nu\varepsilon_t^{ik}\right\} &= \beta V_{t+1}^{ik} - \tau^{nj,ik} + \nu\varepsilon_t^{ik}
\end{aligned}$$

This can only be true if for all $mh \neq ik$, $\beta V_{t+1}^{mh} - \tau^{nj,mh} + \nu\varepsilon_t^{mh} \leq \beta V_{t+1}^{ik} - \tau^{nj,ik} + \nu\varepsilon_t^{ik}$. Rewriting this expression, we can say

$$\varepsilon_t^{mh} - \varepsilon_t^{ik} \leq \frac{\beta\left(V_{t+1}^{ik} - V_{t+1}^{mh}\right) - \left(\tau^{nj,ik} - \tau^{nj,mh}\right)}{\nu}$$

let $\bar{\varepsilon}_t^{ik,mh} = \frac{\beta\left(V_{t+1}^{ik} - V_{t+1}^{mh}\right) - \left(\tau^{nj,ik} - \tau^{nj,mh}\right)}{\nu}$, which implies

$$\varepsilon_t^{mh} \leq \bar{\varepsilon}_t^{ik,mh} + \varepsilon_t^{ik}$$

Therefore, the probability that the idiosyncratic shock for every $mh \neq ik$ does not maximize expected future utility is therefore given by the joint probability density $f\left(\varepsilon_t^{ik}\right) \prod_{mh \neq ik} F\left(\bar{\varepsilon}_t^{ik,mh} + \varepsilon_t^{ik}\right)$. Taking the expectation over the continuum of idiosyncratic shocks thus takes the form

$$\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \left(\beta V_{t+1}^{ik} - \tau^{nj,ik} + \nu \varepsilon_t^{ik}\right) f\left(\varepsilon_t^{ik}\right) \prod_{mh \neq ik} F\left(\bar{\varepsilon}_t^{ik,mh} + \varepsilon_t^{ik}\right) d\varepsilon_t^{ik}$$

This gives the contribution from a single market. Therefore, by the law of total expectation, the average option value from moving from market nj can be found by summing over all households

$$\Phi_t^{nj} = \sum_{ik} \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \left(\beta V_{t+1}^{ik} - \tau^{nj,ik} + \nu \varepsilon_t^{ik}\right) f\left(\varepsilon_t^{ik}\right) \prod_{mh \neq ik} F\left(\bar{\varepsilon}_t^{ik,mh} + \varepsilon_t^{ik}\right) d\varepsilon_t^{ik}$$

We assume that the idiosyncratic shocks follow a Type-1 Extreme Value distribution. Substituting the PDF and CDF and with some algebra, we get

$$\begin{aligned}
\Phi_t^{nj} &= \sum_{ik} \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \left(\beta V_{t+1}^{ik} - \tau^{nj,ik} + \nu \varepsilon_t^{ik}\right) f\left(\varepsilon_t^{ik}\right) \prod_{mh \neq ik} F\left(\bar{\varepsilon}_t^{ik,mh} + \varepsilon_t^{ik}\right) d\varepsilon_t^{ik} \\
&= \sum_{ik} \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \left(\beta V_{t+1}^{ik} - \tau^{nj,ik} + \nu \varepsilon_t^{ik}\right) e^{\left(-\varepsilon_t^{ik} - \gamma\right)} e^{\left(-e^{\left(-\varepsilon_t^{ik} - \gamma\right)} \sum_{ik} e^{\left(-\bar{\varepsilon}_t^{ik,mh}\right)}\right)} d\varepsilon_t^{ik} \\
\lambda_t^{ik} &\equiv \log\left(\sum_{mh} e^{\left(-\bar{\varepsilon}_t^{ik,mh}\right)}\right) \\
\zeta_t^{ik} &= \varepsilon_t^{ik} + \gamma \\
\gamma &\equiv \text{Euler's constant} \\
d\zeta_t^{ik} &= d\varepsilon_t^{ik} \\
\Phi_t^{nj} &= \sum_{ik} \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \left(\beta V_{t+1}^{ik} - \tau^{nj,ik} + \nu \varepsilon_t^{ik}\right) e^{\left(-\zeta_t^{ik}\right)} e^{\left(-e^{\left(-\zeta_t^{ik}\right)} e^{\lambda_t^{ik}}\right)} d\varepsilon_t^{ik} \\
&= \sum_{ik} \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \left(\beta V_{t+1}^{ik} - \tau^{nj,ik} + \nu\left(\zeta_t^{ik} - \gamma\right)\right) \exp\left(-\zeta_t^{ik} - \exp\left(-\left(\zeta_t^{ik} - \lambda_t^{ik}\right)\right)\right) d\zeta_t^{ik} \\
\tilde{y}_t^{ik} &= \zeta_t^{ik} - \lambda_t^{ik} \\
d\tilde{y}_t^{ik} &= d\zeta_t^{ik} \\
\Phi_t^{nj} &= \sum_{ik} \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \left(\beta V_{t+1}^{ik} - \tau^{nj,ik} + \nu\left(\tilde{y}_t^{ik} + \lambda_t^{ik} - \gamma\right)\right) \exp\left(-\left(\lambda_t^{ik} + \tilde{y}_t^{ik}\right) - \exp\left(-\tilde{y}_t^{ik}\right)\right) d\zeta_t^{ik} \\
\Phi_t^{nj} &= \sum_{ik} \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \left(\beta V_{t+1}^{ik} - \tau^{nj,ik} + \nu\tilde{y}_t^{ik} + \nu\lambda_t^{ik} - \nu\gamma\right) \exp\left(-\lambda_t^{ik}\right) \exp\left(-\tilde{y}_t^{ik} - \exp\left(-\tilde{y}_t^{ik}\right)\right) d\zeta_t^{ik} \\
\Phi_t^{nj} &= \sum_{ik} \left[\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \left(\beta V_{t+1}^{ik} - \tau^{nj,ik} - \nu\gamma\right) \exp\left(-\lambda_t^{ik}\right) \exp\left(-\tilde{y}_t^{ik} - \exp\left(-\tilde{y}_t^{ik}\right)\right) d\zeta_t^{ik}\right] \\
&\quad + \sum_{ik} \left[\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \nu\tilde{y}_t^{ik} \exp\left(-\lambda_t^{ik}\right) \exp\left(-\tilde{y}_t^{ik} - \exp\left(-\tilde{y}_t^{ik}\right)\right) d\zeta_t^{ik}\right] \\
&\quad + \sum_{ik} \left[\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \nu\lambda_t^{ik} \exp\left(-\lambda_t^{ik}\right) \exp\left(-\tilde{y}_t^{ik} - \exp\left(-\tilde{y}_t^{ik}\right)\right) d\zeta_t^{ik}\right]
\end{aligned}$$

$$
\begin{aligned}
\Phi_t^{nj} &= \sum_{ik} \left[\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \left(\beta V_{t+1}^{ik} - \tau^{nj,ik} - \nu\gamma\right) \exp\left(-\lambda_t^{ik}\right) \exp\left(-\tilde{y}_t^{ik} - \exp\left(-\tilde{y}_t^{ik}\right)\right) d\tilde{y}_t^{ik} \right] \\
&+ \sum_{ik} \left[\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \nu \tilde{y}_t^{ik} \exp\left(-\lambda_t^{ik}\right) \exp\left(-\tilde{y}_t^{ik} - \exp\left(-\tilde{y}_t^{ik}\right)\right) d\tilde{y}_t^{ik} \right] \\
&+ \sum_{ik} \left[\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \nu \lambda_t^{ik} \exp\left(-\lambda_t^{ik}\right) \exp\left(-\tilde{y}_t^{ik} - \exp\left(-\tilde{y}_t^{ik}\right)\right) d\tilde{y}_t^{ik} \right] \\
\Phi_t^{nj} &= \sum_{ik} \left[\exp\left(-\lambda_t^{ik}\right) \left(\beta V_{t+1}^{ik} - \tau^{nj,ik} - \nu\gamma\right) \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \exp\left(-\tilde{y}_t^{ik} - \exp\left(-\tilde{y}_t^{ik}\right)\right) d\tilde{y}_t^{ik} \right] \\
&+ \sum_{ik} \left[\nu \exp\left(-\lambda_t^{ik}\right) \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \tilde{y}_t^{ik} \exp\left(-\tilde{y}_t^{ik} - \exp\left(-\tilde{y}_t^{ik}\right)\right) d\tilde{y}_t^{ik} \right] \\
&+ \sum_{ik} \left[\nu \lambda_t^{ik} \exp\left(-\lambda_t^{ik}\right) \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \exp\left(-\tilde{y}_t^{ik} - \exp\left(-\tilde{y}_t^{ik}\right)\right) d\tilde{y}_t^{ik} \right] \\
\Phi_t^{nj} &= \sum_{ik} \left[\exp\left(-\lambda_t^{ik}\right) \left(\beta V_{t+1}^{ik} - \tau^{nj,ik} - \nu\gamma\right) \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \exp\left(-\tilde{y}_t^{ik} - \exp\left(-\tilde{y}_t^{ik}\right)\right) d\tilde{y}_t^{ik} \right] \\
&+ \sum_{ik} \left[\nu\gamma \exp\left(-\lambda_t^{ik}\right) \right] \\
&+ \sum_{ik} \left[\nu \lambda_t^{ik} \exp\left(-\lambda_t^{ik}\right) \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \exp\left(-\tilde{y}_t^{ik} - \exp\left(-\tilde{y}_t^{ik}\right)\right) d\tilde{y}_t^{ik} \right]
\end{aligned}
$$

$$
\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \exp\left(-x - \exp\left(-x\right)\right) dx = 1
$$

$$
\begin{aligned}
\Phi_t^{nj} &= \sum_{ik} \exp\left(-\lambda_t^{ik}\right) \left[\beta V_{t+1}^{ik} - \tau^{nj,ik} + \nu \lambda_t^{ik}\right] \\
\Phi_t^{nj} &= \sum_{ik} \left[\exp\left(-\log\left(\sum_{mh} \exp\left(-\bar{\varepsilon}_t^{ik,mh}\right)\right)\right) \left(\beta V_{t+1}^{ik} - \tau^{nj,ik}\right) \right] \\
&+ \sum_{ik} \left[\exp\left(-\log\left(\sum_{mh} \exp\left(-\bar{\varepsilon}_t^{ik,mh}\right)\right)\right) \nu \log\left(\sum_{mh} \exp\left(-\bar{\varepsilon}_t^{ik,mh}\right)\right) \right] \\
\bar{\varepsilon}_t^{ik,mh} &= \frac{\beta\left(V_{t+1}^{ik} - V_{t+1}^{mh}\right) - \left(\tau^{nj,ik} - \tau^{nj,mh}\right)}{\nu}
\end{aligned}
$$

$$
\begin{aligned}
\Phi_t^{nj} &= \sum_{ik} \left[\exp\left(-\log\left(\sum_{mh} \exp\left(-\left(\beta V_{t+1}^{ik} - \tau^{nj,ik}\right) \frac{1}{\nu} \right) \exp\left(\left(\beta V_{t+1}^{mh} - \tau^{nj,mh}\right) \frac{1}{\nu} \right)\right)\right) \begin{pmatrix} \beta V_{t+1}^{ik} - \tau^{nj,ik} \\ +\nu \log\left(\sum_{mh} \exp\left(-\bar{\varepsilon}_t^{ik,mh}\right)\right) \end{pmatrix} \right] \\
\Phi_t^{nj} &= \sum_{ik} \left[\exp\left(-\log\left(\frac{\sum_{mh} \exp\left(\left(\beta V_{t+1}^{mh} - \tau^{nj,mh}\right) \frac{1}{\nu}\right)}{\exp\left(\left(\beta V_{t+1}^{ik} - \tau^{nj,ik}\right) \frac{1}{\nu}\right)} \right)\right) \begin{pmatrix} \beta V_{t+1}^{ik} - \tau^{nj,ik} \\ +\nu \log\left(\sum_{mh} \exp\left(-\bar{\varepsilon}_t^{ik,mh}\right)\right) \end{pmatrix} \right] \\
\Phi_t^{nj} &= \sum_{ik} \left[\frac{\exp\left(\left(\beta V_{t+1}^{ik} - \tau^{nj,ik}\right)^{\frac{1}{\nu}}\right)}{\sum_{mh} \exp\left(\left(\beta V_{t+1}^{mh} - \tau^{nj,mh}\right)^{\frac{1}{\nu}}\right)} \begin{pmatrix} \beta V_{t+1}^{ik} - \tau^{nj,ik} \\ +\nu \log\left(\sum_{mh} \exp\left(-\bar{\varepsilon}_t^{ik,mh}\right)\right) \end{pmatrix} \right] \\
\Phi_t^{nj} &= \sum_{ik} \left[\frac{\exp\left(\left(\beta V_{t+1}^{ik} - \tau^{nj,ik}\right)^{\frac{1}{\nu}}\right)}{\sum_{mh} \exp\left(\left(\beta V_{t+1}^{mh} - \tau^{nj,mh}\right)^{\frac{1}{\nu}}\right)} \begin{pmatrix} \beta V_{t+1}^{ik} - \tau^{nj,ik} \\ +\nu \log\left(\frac{\sum_{mh} \exp\left(\left(\beta V_{t+1}^{mh} - \tau^{nj,mh}\right)^{\frac{1}{\nu}}\right)}{\exp\left(\left(\beta V_{t+1}^{ik} - \tau^{nj,ik}\right)^{\frac{1}{\nu}}\right)} \right) \end{pmatrix} \right] \\
\Phi_t^{nj} &= \sum_{ik} \left[\frac{\exp\left(\left(\beta V_{t+1}^{ik} - \tau^{nj,ik}\right)^{\frac{1}{\nu}}\right)}{\sum_{mh} \exp\left(\left(\beta V_{t+1}^{mh} - \tau^{nj,mh}\right)^{\frac{1}{\nu}}\right)} \begin{pmatrix} \left(\beta V_{t+1}^{ik} - \tau^{nj,ik}\right) - \left(\beta V_{t+1}^{ik} - \tau^{nj,ik}\right) \\ +\nu \log\left[\sum_{mh} \exp\left(\left(\beta V_{t+1}^{mh} - \tau^{nj,mh}\right) \frac{1}{\nu}\right)\right] \end{pmatrix} \right]
\end{aligned}
$$

$$\Phi_t^{nj} = \left[\frac{\sum_{ik} \exp\left(\left(\beta V_{t+1}^{ik} - \tau^{nj,ik} \right)^{\frac{1}{\nu}} \right)}{\sum_{mh} \exp\left(\left(\beta V_{t+1}^{mh} - \tau^{nj,mh} \right)^{\frac{1}{\nu}} \right)} \left(\nu \log \sum_{mh} \exp\left(\left(\beta V_{t+1}^{mh} - \tau^{nj,mh} \right) \right)^{\frac{1}{\nu}} \right) \right]$$

$$\Phi_t^{nj} = \nu \log \sum_{mh} \exp\left(\left(\beta V_{t+1}^{mh} - \tau^{nj,mh} \right) \right)^{\frac{1}{\nu}}$$

Substituting this term back into equation (2), we arrive at our final result

$$V_t^{nj} = U\left(C_t^{nj} \right) + E\left[\max_{\{i,k\}_{i=1,k=0}^{N,J}} \left\{ \beta V_{t+1}^{ik} - \tau^{nj,ik} + \nu \varepsilon_t^{ik} \right\} \right]$$

2.2 Deriving equation (3)

Define $\mu_t^{nj,ik}$ as the fraction of workers that relocate from labor market nj to ik. This fraction can be interpreted as the probability that a given worker moves from labor market nj to ik at time t. This can be interpreted as the probability that the expected utility of moving to ik is greater than nj.

$$\begin{aligned}
\mu_t^{nj,ik} &= \Pr\left(\frac{\beta V_{t+1}^{ik} - \tau^{nj,ik}}{v} + \varepsilon_t^{ik} \geq \max_{mh \neq ik} \left\{ \frac{\beta V_{t+1}^{mh} - \tau^{nj,mh}}{v} + \varepsilon_t^{mh} \right\} \right) \\
&= \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} f\left(\varepsilon_t^{ik} \right) \prod_{mh \neq ik} F\left(\bar{\varepsilon}_t^{ik,mh} + \varepsilon_t^{ik} \right) d\varepsilon_t^{ik} \\
&= \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} e^{\left(-\varepsilon_t^{ik} - \gamma \right)} e^{\left(-e^{\left(-\varepsilon_t^{ik} - \gamma \right)} \sum_{ik} e^{\left(-\bar{\varepsilon}_t^{ik,mh} \right)} \right)} d\varepsilon_t^{ik} \\
&= \exp\left(-\lambda_t^{ik} \right) \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \exp\left(-\tilde{y}_t^{ik} - \exp\left(-\tilde{y}_t^{ik} \right) \right) d\tilde{y}_t^{ik} \\
&= \exp\left(-\log\left(\sum_{mh} e^{\left(-\bar{\varepsilon}_t^{ik,mh} \right)} \right) \right) \\
&= \exp\left(\log\left(\frac{\exp\left(\left(\beta V_{t+1}^{ik} - \tau^{nj,ik} \right) \right)^{\frac{1}{\nu}}}{\sum_{mh} \exp\left(\beta V_{t+1}^{mh} - \tau^{nj,mh} \right)^{\frac{1}{\nu}}} \right) \right) \\
&= \frac{\exp\left(\beta V_{t+1}^{ik} - \tau^{nj,ik} \right)^{\frac{1}{\nu}}}{\sum_{mh} \exp\left(\beta V_{t+1}^{mh} - \tau^{nj,mh} \right)^{\frac{1}{\nu}}}
\end{aligned}$$

The labor market distribution can be though of as a Markov process. Given that $\mu_t^{nj,ik}$ is a transition matrix which represents the probability of being going from state nj to state ik at period $t+1$, we can write our labor distribution as

$$L_{t+1}^{nj} = \sum_{ik} \mu_t^{ik,nj} L_t^{ik}$$

2.3 Proposition 2

"Conditional on an initial allocation of the economy, $(L_0, \pi_0, X_0, \mu_{-1})$, given an anticipated sequence of changes in fundamentals, $\left\{ \dot{\Theta} \right\}_{t=1}^{\infty}$, with $\lim_{t\to\infty} \dot{\Theta}_t = 1$, the solution to the sequential equilibrium in time differences does not require information on the level of the fundamentals, $\{\Theta_t\}_{t=0}^{\infty}$ or $\bar{\Theta}$, and solves the following system of nonlinear equations:

$$\mu_{t+1}^{nj,ik} = \frac{\mu_t^{nj,ik} \left(\dot{u}_{t+2}^{ik} \right)^{\beta/\nu}}{\sum_{mh} \mu_t^{nj.mh} \left(\dot{u}_{t+2}^{mh} \right)^{\beta/\nu}}$$

$$\dot{u}_{t+1}^{nj} = \dot{\omega}\left(\dot{L}_{t+1}, \dot{\Theta}_{t+1}\right)\left(\sum_{ik} \mu^{nj,ik}\left(\dot{u}_{t+2}^{ik}\right)^{\beta/\nu}\right)$$
$$L_{t+1}^{nj} = \sum_{ik} \mu_t^{ik,nj} L_t^{ik}$$

for all j, n, i, and k at each t where $\left\{\dot{\omega}^{nj}\left(\dot{L}_t, \dot{\Theta}_t\right)\right\}_{n=1,j=0,t=1}^{N,J,\infty}$ is the solution to the temporary equilibrium given $\left\{\dot{L}_t, \dot{\Theta}_t\right\}_{t=1}^{\infty}$ "

This proposition gives part of the algorithm required to solve the DP in changes. It's usefulness comes from that fact that we don't need to know the fundamentals of each time period in levels $\left(\Theta_t \equiv (A_t, \kappa_t), \bar{\Theta} \equiv (\mathcal{Y}, H, b)\right)$.

The transition matrix at $t = 0$ is given by

$$\mu_0^{nj,ik} = \frac{\exp\left(\beta V_1^{ik} - \tau^{nj,ij}\right)^{1/\nu}}{\sum_{mh} \exp\left(\beta V_1^{mh} - \tau^{nj,mh}\right)^{1/\nu}}$$

Now dividing by the transition matrix at $t = -1$, which are just the migration flows taken from the data, we get

$$\begin{aligned}
\frac{\mu_0^{nj,ik}}{\mu_{-1}^{nj,ik}} &= \frac{\frac{\exp\left(\beta V_1^{ik} - \tau^{nj,ij}\right)^{1/\nu}}{\sum_{mh} \exp\left(\beta V_1^{mh} - \tau^{nj,mh}\right)^{1/\nu}}}{\frac{\exp\left(\beta V_0^{ik} - \tau^{nj,ij}\right)^{1/\nu}}{\sum_{mh} \exp\left(\beta V_0^{mh} - \tau^{nj,mh}\right)^{1/\nu}}} \\
&= \frac{\exp\left(\beta V_1^{ik} - \beta V_0^{ik}\right)^{1/\nu}}{\frac{\sum_{mh}\left(\beta V_1^{mh} - \tau^{nj,mh}\right)^{1/\nu}}{\sum_{mh} \exp\left(\beta V_0^{mh} - \tau^{nj,mh}\right)^{1/\nu}}} \\
&= \frac{\exp\left(\beta V_1^{ik} - \beta V_0^{ik}\right)^{1/\nu}}{\sum_{mh} \frac{\exp\left(\beta V_1^{mh} - \tau^{nj,mh}\right)^{1/\nu}}{\exp\left(\beta V_0^{mh} - \tau^{nj,mh}\right)^{1/\nu}} \frac{\exp\left(\beta V_0^{mh} - \tau^{nj,mh}\right)^{1/\nu}}{\sum_{mh} \exp\left(\beta V_0^{mh} - \tau^{nj,mh}\right)^{1/\nu}}} \\
&= \frac{\exp\left(V_1^{ik} - V_0^{ik}\right)^{\beta/\nu}}{\sum_{mh} \mu_{-1}^{nj,mh} \exp\left(V_1^{mh} - V_0^{mh}\right)^{\beta/\nu}} \\
\dot{u}_1^{nj} &= \exp\left(V_1^{nj} - V_0^{nj}\right) \\
\mu_0^{nj,ik} &= \frac{\mu_{-1}^{nj,ik}\left(\dot{u}_t^{ik}\right)^{\beta/\nu}}{\sum_{mh} \mu_{-1}^{nj,mh}\left(\dot{u}_t^{mh}\right)^{\beta/\nu}} \\
V_1^{nj} - V_0^{nj} &= U\left(C_1^{nj}\right) - U\left(C_0^{nj}\right) + \nu \log\left(\frac{\beta \sum_{ik} \exp\left(\beta V_2^{ik} - \tau^{nj,ik}\right)^{1/\nu}}{\beta \sum_{ik} \exp\left(\beta V_1^{ik} - \tau^{nj,ik}\right)^{1/\nu}}\right) \\
&= a + \nu \log\left(\sum_{ik} \frac{\exp\left(\beta V_2^{ik} - \tau^{nj,ik}\right)^{1/\nu}}{\exp\left(\beta V_1^{ik} - \tau^{nj,ik}\right)^{1/\nu}} \frac{\exp\left(\beta V_1^{ik} - \tau^{nj,ik}\right)^{1/\nu}}{\sum_{ik} \exp\left(\beta V_1^{ik} - \tau^{nj,ik}\right)^{1/\nu}}\right) \\
&= U\left(C_1^{nj}\right) - U\left(C_0^{nj}\right) + \nu \log\left(\sum_{ik} \mu_0^{nj,ik} \exp\left(V_2^{ik} - V_1^{ik}\right)^{\beta/\nu}\right) \\
&= \log\left(\frac{\dot{w}_t^{nj}}{\dot{P}_t^{nj}}\right) + \nu \log\left(\sum_{ik} \mu_0^{nj,ik} \exp\left(V_2^{ik} - V_1^{ik}\right)^{\beta/\nu}\right) \\
\exp\left(V_1^{nj} - V_0^{nj}\right) &= \exp\left(\log\left(\frac{\dot{w}_t^{nj}}{\dot{P}_t^{nj}}\right) + \nu \log\left(\sum_{ik} \mu_0^{nj,ik} \exp\left(V_2^{ik} - V_1^{ik}\right)^{\beta/\nu}\right)\right) \\
\dot{u}_1^{nj} &= \frac{\dot{w}_1^{nj}}{\dot{P}_1^{nj}}\left(\sum_{ik} \mu_0^{nj,ik}\left(\dot{u}_2^{ik}\right)^{\beta/\nu}\right)^{\nu}
\end{aligned}$$

$$\dot{u}_{t+1}^{nj} = \dot{\omega}^{nj}\left(\dot{L}_{t+1}, \dot{\Theta}_{t+1}\right)\left(\sum_{ik} \mu_t^{nj,ik}\left(\dot{u}_{t+2}^{ik}\right)^{\beta/\nu}\right)^{\nu}$$

2.4 Solution algorithm

To solve the DP problem, we need to know the initial distribution of workers and the transition matrix at $t = 1$. This is taken from the data. The first step is to guess the vector for expected lifetime changes in utility in each market, $\bar{\dot{u}}$. Given this guess, we can use it to solve for our transition matrices for each t and the evolution of labor employment. We use these values $\mathcal{D}\left(\bar{\dot{u}}, \bar{\mu}, \bar{L}\right)$ to solve for our static, temporary equilibrium at each t.

3 Static equilibrium

Solving the static equilibrium given our guesses to the DP problem is straightforward.

The intermediate producer problem is given by

$$\min_{\left\{l_t^{nj}, h_t^{nj}, M_t^{nj,nk}\right\}} w_t l_n^{nj} + r_t h_t^{nj} + P_t^{nk} M_t^{nk,nj}$$

$$\text{s.t. } 1 = z^{nj}\left(A_t^{nj}\left(h_t^{nj}\right)^{\xi^n}\left(l_t^{nj}\right)^{1-\xi^n}\right)^{\gamma^{nj}} \prod_{k=1}^{J}\left(M_t^{nj,nk}\right)^{\gamma^{nj,nk}}$$

The Lagrangian is given by

$$\mathcal{L} = w_t l_t^{nj} + r_t h_t^{nj} + P_t^{nk} M_t^{nk,nj} - \lambda\left(z^{nj}\left(A_t^{nj}\left(h_t^{nj}\right)^{\xi^n}\left(l_t^{nj}\right)^{1-\xi^n}\right)^{\gamma^{nj}} \prod_{k=1}^{J}\left(M_t^{nj,nk}\right)^{\gamma^{nj,nk}} - 1\right)$$

$$\frac{\partial L}{\partial l_t^{nj}} : w_t = \lambda\gamma^{nj}\left(1-\xi^n\right) z^{nj}\left(A_t^{nj}\left(h_t^{nj}\right)^{\xi^n}\left(l_t^{nj}\right)^{1-\xi^n}\right)^{\gamma^{nj}-1}\left(l_t^{nj}\right)^{-\xi^n} \prod_{k=1}^{J}\left(M_t^{nj,nk}\right)^{\gamma^{nj,nk}}$$

$$\frac{\partial L}{\partial h_t^{nj}} : r_t = \lambda\gamma^{nj}\xi^n z^{nj}\left(A_t^{nj}\left(h_t^{nj}\right)^{\xi^n}\left(l_t^{nj}\right)^{1-\xi^n}\right)^{\gamma^{nj}-1}\left(h_t^{nj}\right)^{\xi^n-1} \prod_{k=1}^{J}\left(M_t^{nj,nk}\right)^{\gamma^{nj,nk}}$$

$$\frac{\partial L}{\partial M_t^{nj,nk}} : P_t^{nk} = \lambda z^{nj}\left(A_t^{nj}\left(h_t^{nj}\right)^{\xi^n}\left(l_t^{nj}\right)^{1-\xi^n}\right)^{\gamma^{nj}} \gamma^{nj,nk}\left(M_t^{nj,nk}\right)^{-1} \prod_{k=1}^{J}\left(M_t^{nj,nk}\right)^{\gamma^{nj,nk}}$$

Solving the FOC, we get our factor market clearing equilibrium conditions in levels.

4 Sources

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